

Karan Vasdev

+1 (778) 325-9411 | karanvasdev21@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Personal Website](#)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sama

Toronto, Ontario

Product Manager II

April 2025 – Present

- Leading the [Natural Language Processing \(NLP\) product portfolio](#), driving strategy and development of complex multi-modal and multi-lingual products from 0 to 1, and scaling the portfolio to 25%+ of company revenue in 1 year
- Building [AI-assisted annotation workflows](#) using embeddings retrieval, LLM-based evaluation, stratified sampling, and human-in-the-loop pipelines, improving labeling scalability and quality for enterprise AI training datasets
- Building industry-leading AI data and annotation platforms for enterprise agentic AI, generative AI, and computer vision workflows, used by customers including Nvidia, OpenAI, Google, Walmart, Instacart, and NASA
- Co-authored AI research: “Bulk Annotation for Categorization”, submitted to Association for Computing Machinery

Zenira Partners

Toronto, Ontario

Founder and CEO

October 2024 – Present

- Founded an AI-native consulting business which leverages LLM workflows and automation systems for opportunity sourcing, proposal writing, strategic research, and client acquisition
- Supported \$22M+ in funding opportunities for social impact organizations across affordable housing, healthcare, workforce development, and economic development initiatives

Scotiabank

Toronto, Ontario

Product Manager, Authentication and Fraud

June 2023 – April 2025

- Reduced annual operating costs by \$8M+ and improved authentication experience for 5M+ retail customers by leading development of a [2-Step Verification product feature](#) automating branch and call centre KYC workflows
- Led development of a centralized analytics platform monitoring customer experience and fraud metrics across 30+ authentication journeys spanning 12 mobile and web fintech products
- Led 3 product developments simultaneously, establishing product and technical requirements, prototyping using Figma, Cursor, and Claude Code, and mobilizing agile teams to production and release
- Secured \$12M for two strategic product initiatives by aligning 16 cross-functional stakeholder teams to product vision

Scotiabank

Toronto, Ontario

Product Manager Intern, AI and Machine Learning

May 2022 – August 2022

- Reduced annual costs by \$1.2 million by leading a team of data engineers and data scientists to develop an ML prediction system automating cash supply forecasting across Scotiabank Canadian ATM operations

KPMG

Toronto, Ontario

Management Consultant Intern, Cloud Strategy

May 2021 – August 2021

- Coordinated the delivery of COVID-19 medical supplies to Ontario public institutions, helping 11+ million people

PROJECTS

[Basic RAGSearch](#): Vibecoded a browser-based RAG retrieval demo combining BM25 lexical search, semantic embeddings, and Reciprocal Rank Fusion (RRF) to generate evidence-grounded answers and retrieval diagnostics from research text

[ReusableEats](#): 1st Place Winner at Hack the Globe hosted by Google and Boston Consulting Group; built a circular economy marketplace application to manage reusable takeout containers for restaurants and consumers

EDUCATION

University of British Columbia

Vancouver, British Columbia

Bachelor of Commerce, Business and Computer Science

September 2018 – April 2023

- Academics: 3.9/4.33 GPA; recipient of 3 academic scholarships; Dean's Honour List; Head Teaching Assistant
- Competitions: Won 6 [global and national case competitions and hackathons](#); represented UBC internationally

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, SQL, Java, R, C++, JavaScript, Bash

Tools: Claude, ChatGPT, Cursor, Ollama, GitHub, n8n, Figma, Looker, PowerBI, APIs

Certifications: Anthropic AI Fluency Academy, AI Product Management, Advanced PM Training, APM Canada

INTERESTS

Soccer: Played semi-professionally in South Korea, China, and Japan; won record-number MVP awards at tournaments

International Business: Grew up in 9 countries; avid reader of developmental economics and int'l expansion strategies